regulated enterprise settings, XACML was seen as the future of access control.

Although it was ambitious and comprehensive, XACML struggled to gain traction in practice. Developers found the XML syntax to be verbose and difficult to write and test. Tooling lagged, and the runtime model was not performant enough for many real-world applications. Still, many of its core ideas—centralized policy evaluation, structured decision logic, separation of enforcement and decision—laid the groundwork for what came after.

8.1.1 A XACML simple example

ACME Corp has an internal document archive used by HR and finance, controlled by XACML policies. This in prose expresses one of the rules they'd like to formalize in XACML:

> *Permit access to confidential documents if the requester is in the same department as the document's owner.*

Here's a simplified, partial XACML policy that captures this logic: